

Stephanie Haecker

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Release-focused Test Engineering professional with experience supporting software delivery readiness, release validation, test automation, quality governance, and cross-functional execution across API, UI, integration, and backend/database systems. Currently serving as IT Architect - Test Engineering, combining hands-on technical validation with senior-level leadership in automation strategy, quality process improvement, and release confidence. Experienced with Agile delivery, stakeholder coordination, defect/risk communication, AI-assisted workflows, Playwright/TypeScript, Postman, SQL validation, GitHub, Azure DevOps, and ServiceNow. ISTQB-certified.

TOOLS

AI

- ChatGPT
- Claude
- Cursor
- NotebookLM
- Perplexity AI

AUTOMATION

- Playwright/TypeScript
- Postman
- SoapUI
- TestProject
- TestRail

RELEASE / DEV & COLLABORATION

- Azure DevOps
- GitHub
- ServiceNow
- GitBook
- Redocly
- VS Code
- monday.com
- Pivotal Tracker

SQL

- MySQL
- PostgreSQL
- SQL Server

PLATFORM & PRODUCTIVITY

- Beyond Compare
- Fiddler
- GoAnywhere
- Microsoft 365
- WinSCP

CORE SKILLS

- Release readiness
- Release validation
- Go/No-Go support
- Risk communication
- Deployment readiness
- Agile / Scrum
- API testing
- Database testing
- SQL validation
- Integration testing
- Defect tracking
- Regression testing
- Smoke testing
- Test automation
- Test strategy
- Test data management
- Cross-functional collaboration
- Process improvement
- AI-assisted workflows
- Requirements analysis

CERTIFICATIONS

- CTFL
- CT-Automation Engineer
- CT-Generative AI

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, Communication
Bellevue University

Bachelor of Science, Information Systems
Bellevue University

EXPERIENCE

IT Architect - Test Engineering

Mar 2025 - Present

Nelnet

- Serve as a senior technical contributor for test engineering, driving scalable quality practices across API, backend/database, integration, and UI testing efforts.
- Support release confidence by guiding test strategy, validation planning, automation approach, and readiness assessment across complex application changes.
- Partner with developers, testing teams, and cross-functional stakeholders to troubleshoot issues, validate requirements, communicate quality risks, and support delivery decisions.
- Use Playwright/TypeScript for UI automation, Postman for API validation, and SQL-based analysis to confirm application behavior, data integrity, and system readiness.
- Leverage AI-assisted workflows to reduce manual testing estimates by 25% and test preparation effort by 25%, improving requirement coverage and execution efficiency.
- Assess testing tools, processes, and quality workflows for consistency, usability, maintainability, and long-term supportability.

Lead - Test Engineering

Jun 2022 - Mar 2025

Nelnet

- Led testing efforts across projects and initiatives to support quality objectives, delivery readiness, and alignment with business and system needs.
- Coordinated testing scope, execution priorities, defect follow-up, and validation activities to support release readiness across multiple initiatives.
- Partnered with testing, development, delivery, and business stakeholders to align expectations, clarify dependencies, and improve release quality.
- Guided improvements to automation frameworks and testing approaches to strengthen coverage, maintainability, and execution efficiency.
- Communicated testing progress, risks, and outcomes in clear, actionable language to support informed delivery and release decisions.

Senior Test Engineer

May 2021 - Jun 2022

Nelnet

- Analyzed business and technical requirements to support testing of application functionality, system integrations, data flows, and compliance needs.
- Created and maintained automated test suites covering API, backend/database, integration, and UI testing scenarios.
- Validated outcomes through SQL queries, data analysis, and expected-versus-actual comparisons to confirm data integrity and application behavior.
- Supported release validation by executing smoke, regression, interface, API, and data-focused testing activities.
- Documented, tracked, retested, and communicated defects, working closely with developers to support timely resolution.

Test Engineer

Aug 2019 - May 2021

Nelnet

- Supported quality efforts across smoke, regression, interface, API, data, and UI testing.
- Applied manual and automated testing practices throughout SDLC and STLC processes in Agile and Scrum-based environments.
- Participated in user acceptance testing and release validation activities to help confirm product readiness.
- Created and maintained test cases, test data, and documentation to improve testing consistency and repeatability.